

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Sixth-century BCE shramana field

AGRARIAN SURPLUS + CITIES + MAHAJANAPADAS + MERCHANTS + RITUAL QUESTIONING

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SHRAMANA FIELD

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JAINA

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BUDDHIST

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AJIVIKA

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other schools

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Heterodoxy is not one anti-Brahmana bloc; doctrines and disciplines differ.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Jain cosmos, bondage and liberation

JIVA (conscious) + AJIVA (non-conscious) -> beginningless cosmos without creator

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action/passions attract karmic matter -> bondage and repeated birth

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samvara stops influx + nirjara sheds karma -> kevala-jnana -> moksha

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Liberation is purification of an enduring individual soul, not annihilation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Jain path and many-sided knowledge

TRIRATNA: right faith + right knowledge + right conduct

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FIVE VOWS: ahimsa | satya | asteya | brahmacharya | aparigraha

monastic mahavrata = rigorous | lay anuvrata = limited practicable form

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ANEKANTAVADA -> NAYAVADA standpoints -> SYADVADA qualified predication

Many-sidedness disciplines claims; it does not make contradictions equally true.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Jain community, canon and spread

Parshvanatha -> Mahavira -> fourfold sangha -> councils/redactions -> sects
23rd Tirthankara 24th monks/nuns/lay Pataliputra/Valabhi Digambara/Shvetambara
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patronage and merchants -> Mathura, western India, Karnataka -> temples/literature
Sect differences include clothing, canon and liberation questions.
Avoid reducing separation to one famine story or treating all traditions as identical.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Buddhist diagnosis and disciplined path

DUKKHA -> SAMUDAYA (craving/ignorance) -> NIRODHA -> EIGHTFOLD PATH



MIDDLE WAY rejects indulgence and self-mortification; nirvana ends causes of dukkha.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Dependent origination and no-self

ignorance -> formations -> consciousness -> name-form -> six senses -> contact
-> feeling -> craving -> clinging -> becoming -> birth -> ageing-and-death

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conditioned arising explains continuity without eternal atman or first creator.

aggregates: form, feeling, perception, formations, consciousness -> impermanent/anatta

karma preserves ethical causation through process; nirvana is not physical death.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Buddhist sangha, councils and canons

BUDDHA/DHAMMA -> monastic SANGHA under VINAYA <-> lay gifts, merit and protection

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conventional councils: Rajagriha -> Vaishali -> Pataliputra -> regional recensions

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Pali Tipitaka: Vinaya + Sutta + Abhidhamma; other witnesses survive in Sanskrit, Chinese and Tibetan traditions. Councils are sectarian memories, not court minutes. Women ordain, but institutional hierarchy and textual debate remain.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Buddhist developments: schools to Vajrayana

EARLY SCHOOLS -> MAHAYANA -> MADHYAMAKA/YOGACARA -> VAJRAYANA

Vinaya/Abhidharma bodhisattva ideal emptiness/mind debates mantra/mandala/tantra

multiple nikayas new sutras philosophy systems ritual monasteries

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Theravada is one surviving early tradition; Hinayana is a polemical label, not synonym.

Maitreya/paramitas fit Mahayana; Vajrayana is a later development.

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Networks, material culture and outcomes

GANGA HEARTLAND -> stupas/monasteries -> trade routes and political patronage

Mauryan/post-Mauryan support -> Sanchi, Bharhut and caves -> donors/artisans

NORTH-WEST/CENTRAL ASIA -> Silk routes -> China -> Korea/Japan

SRI LANKA -> Theravada transmission -> Southeast Asian histories

JAIN NETWORKS -> Mathura/western India/Deccan/Karnataka -> temples/manuscripts

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Buddhism later declined/absorbed in India as patronage and monastery networks changed;
Jainism persisted through lay institutions, regional patrons and adaptive communities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Jainism-Buddhism comparison and answer spine

AXIS: Jain jiva vs Buddhist anatta | karmic matter vs conditioned process

PATH: vows/austerity/triratna vs middle way/eightfold path

10 MARKS: doctrine -> mechanism/path -> named term -> distinction/caution

15 MARKS: context -> doctrine -> institution -> patronage/spread -> limitation

20 MARKS: shramana setting -> both systems -> councils/schools/material culture
-> controlled comparison -> decline/persistence -> source qualification

CLOSE: both recast ethics/liberation through fundamentally different selves and paths.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. # Claim Named evidence Significance Limitation
3. Year Paper Q PYQ demand (neutral rendering) Directive / format Source...

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
2. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...
3. Dimension Evidence Historical use Limit

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.